

How Volcanoes Form: answers

Grade 6 · 14 points. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. Giant slabs that Earth's crust is broken into. (1 point)

Finding information (RI.6.1). A key term defined in the first section.

2. One plate sliding beneath another plate. Evidence: "a heavy ocean plate slides beneath another plate in a process called subduction." (2 points)

Word meaning (RI.6.4). The meaning is in the sentence, so the child must point to the evidence.

3. "The melted rock, called magma, is lighter than the rock around it, so it slowly rises." (2 points)

Quoting from the text (RI.6.1). Copying the exact sentence that answers a question, a core Grade 6 skill.

4. They take an extremely long time. Evidence: the plates move "only an inch or two each year" and it takes "millions of years" to reshape continents. (2 points)

Inference (RI.6.1). Drawing a conclusion and backing it up with exact details.

5. Hot-spot volcanoes form where hot material melts through the crust, even "far from the edge of a plate," while most volcanoes form where two plates meet. (2 points)

Explaining from the text. Comparing two ideas with evidence from the text.

6. 1. Rock melts to form magma. 2. Magma rises toward the surface. 3. Magma collects in a magma chamber. 4. Magma forces its way up through a vent. (2 points)

Sequencing events. Following a process through several steps.

7. Both are caused by the same moving plates. The text says earthquakes happen there "because both are caused by the same moving plates." (2 points)

Inference (RI.6.1). Using a cause stated in the text to explain a pattern.

8. B (1 point)

Summarizing (RI.6.2). The central idea covers the whole text. The wrong answers are too narrow or untrue.